



Request for Proposal (RFP): Basalt Chamber of Commerce Website Redesign

updated 9/1/2026

Release date: August 21, 2026

Questions due: September 4, 2026

Proposal deadline: September 18, 2026 at 5 p.m. MDT | *The chamber reserves the right to begin reviewing proposals and conducting interviews as qualified proposals are received.*

9/1/2026 UPDATE:

As a chamber of commerce, our organization's mission is based on supporting local businesses. As such, we will only consider proposals within North America, ideally Colorado-based.

***Common prospective FAQs will be added to the end of this document to provide greater clarification - [Click here](#)

Introduction

The Basalt Chamber of Commerce is seeking a qualified and experienced website design and development agency to redesign and rebuild our website, basaltchamber.org. Our current website was launched in 2019, and no longer meets the evolving needs of our members and the community. We require a modern, user-friendly, responsive website that accurately reflects our brand while effectively communicating our mission and services, as well as visitor information.

We are looking for a long-term partner, not a transactional vendor. The ideal partner will collaborate closely with our team during the build and provide ongoing support, technical maintenance, and strategic guidance post-launch to keep the site current with emerging technologies and accessibility standards. Our intent is to work with someone that really **gets** the chamber, and is committed to ensuring a positive web experience for each of our user types, ultimately making the organization (and our community) stronger.

Staff prefers a collaborative environment, and the selected vendor will be encouraged to provide honest feedback and creative ideas on improvements and opportunities for efficiency after the new website is delivered. This is not a set-it-and-forget-it project.

Organization Overview

The Basalt Chamber of Commerce is a 501(c)6 nonprofit membership organization of approximately 400 members. The chamber is dedicated to promoting and supporting the economic vitality of the Basalt, Colorado business community. We serve as a resource for local businesses, residents, and visitors, providing networking opportunities, advocacy, and promoting community events, while also serving as a destination management organization (DMO).

Current Site Context & Technical Challenges

The current site was created in 2018. Since then, the original firm that designed it has been sold twice. We ultimately discovered that the site was “like you went to the Ford Dealer, and they gave you a Ford Truck but under the hood they put a home-made engine.” While the site is technically on Wordpress with a ChamberMaster integration (under Module 3), the content appears to be coded into a php database and does not have any sort of editor.

As a result, it has been almost impossible to update the site in terms of plugins, security updates and more. The site is currently on ~~WordPress 6.2.9~~ [Update: As of September 1, 2026 \(due to a hack\), the site is now on 7.1](#)). Previous updates have resulted in major issues and the need to restore from backups.

Given that the site is currently held together with duct tape and long on borrowed time, the chamber is also open to a phased approach for the redesign, including the launch of a minimally viable product, followed by a planned, scaled set of ongoing upgrades and point releases.

The chamber never wants to repeat this experience, which is why future proofing is critical.

Target Audiences

As a chamber of commerce and a destination management organization, the website (or websites) need to fulfill a variety of communication needs. The goal is to create a positive user experience - regardless of audience type - and for the site to be technologically sound - both now and in the future - while integrated with the chamber's CRM - ChamberMaster.

The website should be a hub of information, with three main audiences:

- Tourists/Area Visitors (Destination marketing, lodging, dining, recreation, arts & culture, local events).
- Basalt Chamber members and the business community (Directory, resources, advocacy, member portal, self-promotional tools).
- Residents local to Basalt and midvalley (Community news, events, local business support)

The site should help audiences explore Basalt and the mid-Roaring Fork Valley, while providing value to our chamber member businesses. In many instances, the information these audiences seek overlap greatly with one another. Additionally, as a business organization, our goal is to lead by example - implementing best practices in all aspects of the website.

The BCC is interested in receiving website redesign proposals that achieve the above, while balancing the involvement of chamber staff during the redesign process. Currently staff manages all content creation needs.

Key Project Objectives

- Enhance user experience: Create a user-friendly and intuitive website that is easy to navigate and provides a seamless experience across all devices for a variety of users/audiences.
- Modernize design: Develop a visually appealing and contemporary design that reflects the Basalt Chamber of Commerce brand and the unique character of our community.
- Seamless Integrations: Integrate cleanly with ChamberMaster/GrowthZone for member directory, calendar of events, and [banner advertisements](#).
- Increase member engagement: Provide members with easy access to resources, events, and networking opportunities as well as self-promotional opportunities (content).
- Provide design and content flexibility: The current code, plugins and widgets are incredibly limiting when it comes to the presentation of information, resulting in large walls of text and limited hierarchy.
- Enhance community outreach: Effectively communicate our mission, services, and events to the wider community and visitors.
- Accessibility Compliance: Meet or exceed WCAG 2.1 AA standards and support language equity (e.g., Spanish accessibility via translation tools/plugins).
- Future-Proofing & GEO Optimization: Build a scalable architecture that accommodates AI-driven search crawlers (Generative Engine Optimization) and ongoing technology updates.
- Serve as a major resource: Become a central hub for Basalt businesses, residents, and tourists.
- Targeted content delivery: Effectively cater to three distinct audience groups: chamber members/business owners, residents, tourists, with tailored content experiences.
- Lead by example: Serve as a model to our members and the business community as a whole when it comes to a well designed, compliant, searchable, accessible website.

Collaborative Approach & Division of Labor

As noted above - the chamber is looking to take a collaborative, partnership approach to the redesign of this website, leveraging the skills of its current staff and existing contractors ("Chamber team") in conjunction with the selected vendor's team/freelancers. The Chamber

team has experience in communications and marketing, graphic design, user experience, content creation, and digital marketing, including having previously managed website re-design projects. This is not our first rodeo, but we also don't know (or can do) it all. The team will want to be actively involved in the non-technical portions of the project, while recognizing our own capacity constraints and technical limitations.

Additionally, as subject matter experts for much of the content, the team will assist with copyediting, fact checking and research to ensure the accuracy of the website and that it adheres to the chamber's brand and style standards.

Estimated Division of Responsibilities

Task / Deliverable	Chamber Role	Vendor / Agency Role
Information Architecture / Sitemap	Co-create	Advise, Co-create & Validate Best Practices
Copywriting & Media Assets	Provide / Refresh *open to contractor assistance	Review / Format for Web & SEO
UX & Design Strategy	Provide Feedback / Assist in Development of Brand Guidelines	Wireframing, UI Design, Mockups
Custom CMS & Frontend Dev	Review & Test	Lead Development (WordPress)
ChamberMaster / API Integration	Account access & Testing	Technical Execution & Styling
SEO & GEO Strategy	Advise on Content & Keyword Strategy	Content & Keyword Strategy, Technical Schema, Technical SEO & Audits
QA & Accessibility Testing	Beta Testing & Verification	Lead Auditing & WCAG Compliance

Content creation

Historically, chamber staff has worked in conjunction with vendors (primary and secondary) to create and source content. Due to the annual Discover Basalt magazine, the chamber has a significant library of past articles as well as a photo library, which can be leveraged for this project (8+ years). That said, the expectation is that the website vendor will contribute to the content creation process, assisting the chamber with copyediting (in-house/freelancer) to supplement what the chamber has already created.

The chamber's current content includes:

- INDD/AI Map files for around town exploration
- A significant photo library, active summer shoots in progress + the ability to shoot more images if needed

- Existing website content that will be updated/refreshed (by staff).
- Brand standards (ish) - while there isn't a complete brand book, there are general standards that we follow.

Staff can contribute time associated with the design process, including copyediting, fact checking and research.

Scope of Work & Technical Requirements

Core Development & CMS

- CMS: WordPress (preferred), giving staff full editability post-launch.
- Responsive Design: Mobile-first approach optimized for desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- Performance & Security: Robust security measures and site speed optimization.
- Asset Ownership: The Chamber must* own all account aspects of the website, domain, hosting, Google Tag Manager, Google Analytics, Google Cloud APIs, and software licenses. Costs associated with these items will be paid for by the Chamber. Proposals should include hosting recommendations/options. *Alternative arrangements within reason will also be considered.

Features & Integrations

- CRM: Seamless integration with ChamberMaster (including [Version 4 Module elements](#) / business.basaltchamber.org pages - likely CSS/wrapper) for member management, directories, calendars, and portal access.
 - See below for API information
- Destination Marketing: Custom pages showcasing lodging, retail, dining, recreation, map files for around-town exploration, standard WordPress blog, and annual events pages.
- Chamber/EDC: Custom pages showcasing Chamber programs, services, and benefits, including the content-intense [Chamber Pass Program](#).
- Business Development: Content highlighting business opportunities, plus a downloadable document/content library for business resources.
- Audience-Specific Landing Pages: Creation of distinct landing pages for each audience (Tourists/Residents, Chamber Members, Business Owners) with dynamically loaded, relevant content.
- Advertising Opportunities: The chamber is looking to integrate banner advertising to generate non-dues revenue. ChamberMaster has this feature.
- Accessibility & Language Equity: WCAG 2.1 AA compliance and Spanish language access via translation plugins/tools.
- Website performance optimization: Reasonable load times are expected and pages must load quickly enough to prevent high-bounce rates.
- Future-proofing: Development of custom features and functionalities as needed.

Content Migration & Creation

- Migration of the majority of existing content from the current website to the new website:
 - Pages: 145 total (98 Published, 47 drafts)
 - Posts: 120 total (97 Published, 22 drafts)
 - Media: 1,059 items
 - NOTE: Staff will assist with a content audit and identify non-essential elements prior to migration.
- Available Resources: Staff will update existing content and can leverage an 8+ year photo/article library from our annual Discover Basalt magazine (plus ongoing photoshoots).
- Vendor Contribution: Vendor/freelance support is expected to assist staff with copyediting and content optimization.

Training and Documentation

- Provide comprehensive training for Chamber staff on website management and content updates.
- Develop clear and concise documentation for website maintenance.

Post-Launch Support and Maintenance

- Provide ongoing technical support and maintenance for a specified period (e.g., 6 or 12 months).
- Offer a plan for ongoing website updates and maintenance to keep pace with emerging technology, website trends and accessibility standards.
- Additionally - option for regular reporting of site analytics, including recommendations for potential content opportunities.

Project Phasing & Timeline Requirements

Target Go-Live Date: Q1 2027

NOTE: Open to a phased rollout or Minimum Viable Product (MVP) launch prior to this date if necessary.

Post-Launch Maintenance: Proposal must include ongoing technical support, plugin updates, security monitoring, and accessibility compliance checks for at least 6 months post-launch, with monthly support package following.

Proposal Requirements

Vendors must include the following in their submission:

- Company Profile & Team: Brief history, key team members assigned to this project, and relevant chamber, tourism or nonprofit experience.

- Project Approach & Methodology: Detailed explanation of how you will execute the redesign and collaborate with our capable internal team, including timelines and milestones.
- Design Portfolio & References: 3–4 examples of relevant work, especially membership/tourism web projects, plus contact info for three (3) client references.
- Technical & Integration Plan: Outline of WordPress setup, ChamberMaster integration strategy, GEO/Schema implementation, and WCAG compliance plan.
- Detailed Budget & Cost Breakdown:
 - Design & Development Fee
 - Content Migration / Integration Support
 - Estimated Third-Party Plugin/Software Costs
 - Post-Launch Support & Maintenance Plan (Monthly or Annual)
 - Target Budget Range: Proposals in the range of \$30,000 to \$45,000 will be given primary consideration.
- Future-Proofing Plan: Proposed approach to ongoing platform updates, security, and technology adaptations over time.

Submission Guidelines & Formatting

Proposals must be submitted electronically to Kris Mattera, President & CEO at director@basaltchamber.org by September 18, 2026.

Format: PDF or Word doc via email with subject line: RFP Response: Basalt Chamber Website - [Vendor Name].

Page Limit: Maximum of 20 pages (excluding portfolio links and appendix).

Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated based on the following criteria:

- Experience and Qualifications: Demonstrated experience in website design and development, particularly for non-profit or membership-based organizations, with relevant integrations.
- Technical Expertise: Proficiency in WordPress, CRM integration, SEO, and accessibility standards. ChamberMaster experience a plus.
- Design Quality and Portfolio Relevance: Creativity and quality of design portfolio.
- Project Approach & Alignment with Internal Team: Clarity and feasibility of the proposed project approach.
- Cost Effectiveness & Value: Competitiveness and transparency of the cost proposal.
- Timeline: Realistic and achievable project timeline.
- References: Positive client feedback.

- Maintenance and Support Plan: Quality of the post-launch support and maintenance plan and cost.
- Future Proofing Plan: Quality of the plan to keep the website current.

Schedule & Contact Information

Questions due: September 4, 2026

Questions regarding this RFP should be directed to Kris Mattera, President & CEO at director@basaltchamber.org or (970) 927-4031.

Proposal deadline: September 18, 2026 | *The chamber reserves the right to begin reviewing proposals and conducting interviews as qualified proposals are received.*

UPDATE: Prospective Vendor FAQs

Point of contact/approvals

Kris Mattera, President & CEO will be the internal chamber staff lead. She is the final approver for all designs, however approval of the project budget lies with the board of directors. A tentative amount has been earmarked for this project, however if a proposal is selected that is above the target range, there may be a need to get board approval due to their fiduciary oversight.

ChamberMaster version

Our CRM is currently at the [Plus](#) level. As part of this project, we anticipate upgrading to Premium or Pro, in order to gain access to the [Banner Ads feature](#). We have been holding off on upgrading to the advertising module so as to not incur additional expenses until necessary. Ad space should be included in the initial design process.

We do not intend to upgrade to GrowthZone at this time.

ChamberMaster support and technical information is publicly available online:

<https://helpdesk.chambermaster.com/hc/en-us>

We believe the current site is leveraging CSS on an existing template base. We are currently on Module 3 and would like to go to 4. Helpful links:

<https://integration.growthzone.com/v4-modules/>

<https://helpdesk.chambermaster.com/hc/en-us/articles/46973589227291-Website-Modules>

<https://business.basaltchamber.org/integration>

Our neighbors Carbondale are on Module 4: <https://chamber.carbondale.com/list/>

Updated 9/8 - **We are open to either Module 4 or the API - the intent is to have a nice looking site AND for staff to not have to duplicate work when we have a CRM that contains member information, events, job postings and other functionality. Carbondale's site is an example of the minimum standard.**

ChamberMaster API

Many prospective vendors asked about API integration with ChamberMaster. I reached out to CM support and we now have an API key (which would be provided to the selected vendor)

API documentation: <https://integration.growthzone.com/chambermaster-memberzone-api/>

Complete list of all API endpoints: <https://api.micronetonline.com/v1/documentation>

The key goes in the request headers under the name X-APIKey.

Please note that all support for the CM API is limited to the provided online written documentation.

Updated 9/8 - We are not aware of any sandbox or dev environment for ChamberMaster, but we do have a ticket submitted.

Content migration

Of the pages / posts / media items, we anticipate migrating 80-90% of the written content (which will likely need to be updated, as some pages haven't been modified since 2019).

Chamber staff plan to work on the updated copy, and the numbers included in this document are pre-audit. As for the media, assuming the design of the site will change, we assume many photos will need to be resized and optimized for site speed (some images are massive, causing slower load times). Similar to the editorial copy, many photos currently on the site are outdated and will need to be replaced, using our photo library.

In some instances, Destinations and Activities within Wordpress (custom post types) include real content, while some are aggregators. In other instances, due to the limitations of the site, staff "hacked" some of the functionality to get content on other pages (see the [Concerts page](#), scroll to About the Bands. Each band is actually set up as a Destination). During a site migration, this content would likely be consolidated into an archive concerts page).

Updated 9/8 - Many existing drafts can be cleaned up or copied off the site, as these are more for reference. Since we lack a dev/test site, draft page have been used to stage content before being copied into a live page. Ex. For our annual holiday promotions, we copy the existing

content into a new draft, make updates for the current year, then overwrite the live page content. Typically we keep a backup draft of the original content for reference.

Content rewrites/updates

Updated 9/8 - The majority of this will be handled by Chamber staff/contractors as we are the SMEs. We are looking for vendor support in applying best practices for SEO, GEO, and other areas to ensure the content is able to be found.

If a vendor has someone who can assist with content, please include this as a separate line item.

[Photo library example.](#)

Chamber Pass Program content

The RFP notes that this is "content intensive". This is because it is a complicated program with lots of information for our members to take in. We try to put as much information online as we have over 65% of our members (265 businesses) participating. If the chamber poorly communicates how it works, staff must deal with a large volume of emails and phone calls. The website is used to mitigate this through good documentation.

This program is single-handedly the highest membership touchpoint we have all year, so its success is incredibly important.

We recommend looking at the current pages for additional context:

<https://basaltchamber.org/belong/membership/benefits/ski-pass/>

<https://basaltchamber.org/belong/membership/benefits/ski-pass/faqs/>

<https://basaltchamber.org/belong/membership/benefits/ski-pass/audit/>

<https://basaltchamber.org/belong/membership/benefits/ski-pass/digital/>

Due to limited functionality and design features, these pages are walls of text, which should be avoided in a new site.

Spanish language translation

Machine language/AI/A plug-in that can translate well will work fine. Our community uses [ReachWell](#) for emergency alerts, which translates messages into 130+ languages. This level of accessibility works for our community, so something similar would suffice for our audiences' needs.

If specific pages targeted at Spanish-speaking audiences are needed, we will engage with a local translation company who knows our community.

Phased/MVP approach

Whether a phased/MVP or single release of the new website, the budgetary guidelines remain. What is most important is transparency in pricing and work.

In terms of what would need to be in an MVP launch - After looking at Google Analytics ([Top 50 pages from the past 12 months](#)), likely our top 10 tourism facing pages, and relevant top 10 chamber pages, and whatever season is approaching near the MVP launch (i.e. if during Q4 2026, I need to have some content for the holiday season and our shop local campaigns). I can also envision approaching a launch with select important/popular pages being updated (editorial, photos), while bringing over the remaining existing context and updating it over time.

Some of our content is very seasonal: The [concert series](#) is only during the summer months and the 2027 schedule will not be available until Q2. The Chamber Pass Program peak months are July-November, however the [audit information](#) is needed Dec-Feb.

Post-launch support + Budget

Updated 9/8 - Ideally the first 6 months of support is included, but please feel free to include this as a separate line item. Our goal is to have transparency in costs both for the site launch and the ongoing maintenance. We've seen vendors where the site cost was in budget, but the over \$1,000 month maintenance was unaffordable.